

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — NATYASHASTRA AND DRAMATIC MODES Lokadhami denotes realistic representation of daily life, while
02	FOUNDATION — RUPAKAS AND THE SUTRADHAR The rupaka-Sutradhar relationship connects dramatic genre
03	FOUNDATION — CHARACTER AND LANGUAGE ON STAGE Evidence chain: Character and language register Qualified use:
04	CORE — CONVENTION AND CLOSURE The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male
05	CORE — WHY SANSKRIT THEATRE CONTRACTED Evidence chain: Named decline mechanisms Qualified use: Build a
06	CORE — KUTTYATTAM AS LIVING CONTINUITY Evidence chain: Kuttyattam continuity Qualified use: Qualify the
07	CORE — FOLK THEATRE'S CHANGING PUBLIC Evidence chain: Folk-theatre arc Qualified use: Prepare
08	CORE — COLONIAL PROSCENIUM AND CENSORSHIP Evidence chain: Modern proscenium and law Qualified use: Link form,
09	CORE — PARS, IPTA AND INSTITUTIONS Commercial, political and state-supported theatres are distinct.
10	CORE — FOUR PUPPETRY MECHANISMS Evidence chain: Four puppetry mechanisms Qualified use: Create the
11	CORE — STRING-PUPPET REGIONAL GRAMMAR Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed
12	CORE — SHADOW-PUPPET SCREEN GRAMMAR Technically, CORE — Shadow-puppet screen grammar is analysed by
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — ROD, GLOVE AND CONTROL Evidence chain: Rod and glove distinctions Qualified use: Complete
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — PUPPETRY AS ARCHIVE AND LIVELIHOOD One 2020 example does not prove every form is secure.
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — MARTIAL PERFORMANCE AND TWO DECLINE TYPES Current status with a dated example: puppetry is documented as

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Natyashastra dramaturgy?	5
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Natyashastra dramaturgy?	5
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Natyashastra dramaturgy?	5
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Natyashastra dramaturgy?	5
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?	6
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?	6
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?	6
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?	6
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Ten rupakas?	7
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Ten rupakas?	7
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ten rupakas?	7
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ten rupakas?	7
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Sutradhar function?	8
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Sutradhar function?	8
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sutradhar function?	8
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sutradhar function?	8
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Character and language register?	9
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Character and language register?	9
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Character and language register?	9
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Character and language register?	9
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Dramaturgical convention?	10
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Dramaturgical convention?	10
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dramaturgical convention?	10
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dramaturgical convention?	10
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Named decline mechanisms?	11
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Named decline mechanisms?	11
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Named decline mechanisms?	11

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Named decline mechanisms?	11
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Kutiyattam continuity?	12
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Kutiyattam continuity?	12
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kutiyattam continuity?	12
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kutiyattam continuity?	12
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Folk-theatre arc?	13
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Folk-theatre arc?	13
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Folk-theatre arc?	13
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Folk-theatre arc?	13
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Modern proscenium and law?	14
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Modern proscenium and law?	14
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Modern proscenium and law?	14
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Modern proscenium and law?	14
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Parsi and political theatre?	15
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Parsi and political theatre?	15
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parsi and political theatre?	15
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parsi and political theatre?	15
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Institutional modern stage?	16
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Institutional modern stage?	16
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Institutional modern stage?	16
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Institutional modern stage?	16
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Four puppetry mechanisms?	17
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Four puppetry mechanisms?	17
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four puppetry mechanisms?	17
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four puppetry mechanisms?	17
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies String-puppet distinctions?	18
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under String-puppet distinctions?	18
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of String-puppet distinctions?	18
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about String-puppet distinctions?	18
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Shadow-puppet distinctions?	19
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Shadow-puppet distinctions?	19
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Shadow-puppet distinctions?	19

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Shadow-puppet distinctions?	19
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Rod and glove distinctions?	20
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Rod and glove distinctions?	20
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rod and glove distinctions?	20
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rod and glove distinctions?	20
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Puppetry as archive?	21
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Puppetry as archive?	21
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Puppetry as archive?	21
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Puppetry as archive?	21
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Current puppetry vulnerability?	22
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Current puppetry vulnerability?	22
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Current puppetry vulnerability?	22
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Current puppetry vulnerability?	22
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Martial-performance continuum?	23
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Martial-performance continuum?	23
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Martial-performance continuum?	23
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Martial-performance continuum?	23
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Two-decline distinction?	24
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Two-decline distinction?	24
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Two-decline distinction?	24
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Two-decline distinction?	24
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	25
TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT	25
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	29
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	30

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Natyashastra dramaturgy?

A. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. B. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. C. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. D. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Natyashastra dramaturgy?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. C. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. D. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position.

Answer: B. Explanation: Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Natyashastra dramaturgy?

A. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. B. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. C. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. D. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator.

Answer: C. Explanation: Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Natyashastra dramaturgy?

A. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. B. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. C. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. D. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

Answer: D. Explanation: Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?

A. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. B. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. C. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. D. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. C. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. D. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position.

Answer: B. Explanation: Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?

A. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. B. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. C. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. D. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Answer: C. Explanation: Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi?

A. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. B. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. C. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. D. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Ten rupakas?

A. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. B. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. C. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. D. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Ten rupakas?

A. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. B. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. C. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. D. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Ten rupakas?

A. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. B. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. C. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. D. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Ten rupakas?

A. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. B. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. C. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. D. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Sutradhar function?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. C. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. D. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Answer: A. Explanation: In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Sutradhar function?

A. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. B. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. C. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. D. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sutradhar function?

A. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. B. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. C. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: C. Explanation: In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sutradhar function?

A. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. B. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. C. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. D. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator.

Answer: D. Explanation: In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Character and language register?

A. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. B. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. C. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. D. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Character and language register?

A. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. B. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. C. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: B. Explanation: Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Character and language register?

A. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. B. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. C. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: C. Explanation: Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Character and language register?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. C. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. D. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position.

Answer: D. Explanation: Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Dramaturgical convention?

A. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. B. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. C. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Dramaturgical convention?

A. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. B. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. C. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dramaturgical convention?

A. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. B. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. C. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. D. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dramaturgical convention?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. C. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. D. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Named decline mechanisms?

A. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. B. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. C. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. D. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Named decline mechanisms?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. C. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. D. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect.

Answer: B. Explanation: The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Named decline mechanisms?

A. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. B. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. C. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. D. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect.

Answer: C. Explanation: The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Named decline mechanisms?

A. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. B. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. C. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. D. The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts.

Answer: D. Explanation: The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Kutiyattam continuity?

A. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. B. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. C. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. D. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Kutiyattam continuity?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. C. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. D. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Kutiyattam continuity?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. C. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. D. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Kutiyattam continuity?

A. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. B. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. C. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. D. Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Folk-theatre arc?

A. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. B. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. C. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. D. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect.

Answer: A. Explanation: Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Folk-theatre arc?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. C. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. D. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Answer: B. Explanation: Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Folk-theatre arc?

A. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. B. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. C. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. D. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.

Answer: C. Explanation: Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Folk-theatre arc?

A. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. B. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.

Answer: D. Explanation: Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Modern proscenium and law?

A. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. B. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. C. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. D. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies.

Answer: A. Explanation: Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Modern proscenium and law?

A. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. B. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. C. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. D. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertories shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Answer: B. Explanation: Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Modern proscenium and law?

A. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. B. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. C. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. D. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.

Answer: C. Explanation: Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Modern proscenium and law?

A. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. B. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. C. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. D. Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect.

Answer: D. Explanation: Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Parsi and political theatre?

A. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. B. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. C. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. D. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.

Answer: A. Explanation: Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Parsi and political theatre?

A. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. B. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers.

Answer: B. Explanation: Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Parsi and political theatre?

A. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. B. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. C. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. D. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Answer: C. Explanation: Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Parsi and political theatre?

A. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies.

Answer: D. Explanation: Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Institutional modern stage?

A. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. B. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.

Answer: A. Explanation: Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Institutional modern stage?

A. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. B. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. C. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. D. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers.

Answer: B. Explanation: Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Institutional modern stage?

A. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. D. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Answer: C. Explanation: Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Institutional modern stage?

A. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. D. Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Answer: D. Explanation: Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Four puppetry mechanisms?

A. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. B. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. C. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. D. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Four puppetry mechanisms?

A. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. B. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Four puppetry mechanisms?

A. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. B. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. C. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. D. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Four puppetry mechanisms?

A. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. B. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. C. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. D. Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies String-puppet distinctions?

A. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. B. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under String-puppet distinctions?

A. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. B. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. C. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskote, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of String-puppet distinctions?

A. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. B. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskote, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. C. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. D. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about String-puppet distinctions?

A. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. B. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. C. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskote, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. D. Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Shadow-puppet distinctions?

A. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Shadow-puppet distinctions?

A. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. B. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. C. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. D. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Shadow-puppet distinctions?

A. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. B. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. C. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Shadow-puppet distinctions?

A. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. B. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Rod and glove distinctions?

A. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: A. Explanation: Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Rod and glove distinctions?

A. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. B. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. C. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: B. Explanation: Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rod and glove distinctions?

A. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. B. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. C. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. D. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display.

Answer: C. Explanation: Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rod and glove distinctions?

A. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. B. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Puppetry as archive?

A. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. B. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display.

Answer: A. Explanation: References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Puppetry as archive?

A. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. B. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

Answer: B. Explanation: References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Puppetry as archive?

A. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. B. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. C. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. D. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration.

Answer: C. Explanation: References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Puppetry as archive?

A. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. B. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. C. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. D. References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Current puppetry vulnerability?

A. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. B. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. C. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. D. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Current puppetry vulnerability?

A. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. B. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. C. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. D. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Current puppetry vulnerability?

A. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. B. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. C. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. D. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Current puppetry vulnerability?

A. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. B. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. C. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. D. The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Martial-performance continuum?

A. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. B. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Martial-performance continuum?

A. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. B. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. C. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. D. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Martial-performance continuum?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. C. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. D. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Martial-performance continuum?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. C. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. D. Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Two-decline distinction?

A. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. B. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. C. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. D. Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

Answer: A. Explanation: Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Two-decline distinction?

A. Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. B. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. C. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. D. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Two-decline distinction?

A. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. B. Nataka, Prakarana, Bhana, Prahasana, Dima, Vyayoga, Samavakara, Vithi, Ihamriga and Utsrishtikanka form the recorded ten-rupaka classification. C. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. D. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator.

Answer: C. Explanation: Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Two-decline distinction?

A. In Sanskrit theatre the Sutradhar conducts preliminaries and introduces the play; in puppetry the term also evokes the string-holder and narrator. B. Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka are broad character types, and the Vidusaka's traditional Prakrit speech shows language register marking stage position. C. The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. D. Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses.

Answer: D. Explanation: Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

No direct routed PYQ for theatre, puppetry or performance traditions appears in the audited 2018-2026 ledgers used by this authoring engine. Older question references inside the Basic owner remain contextual examples and are not promoted into solved PYQ cards without a controlling routed record.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests theatre or puppetry. This topic supplies vocabulary (Sutradhar, puppetry classification) reusable in any future performance-tradition question and cross-links with topics 08-09 for shared performance-art vocabulary.

8. Exact PYQ application

ANALYSIS: No GS-I Mains question in the audited 2024-2025 papers directly tests this topic. An advanced answer on a hypothetical question about safeguarding declining performance traditions should use the completed- vs-ongoing decline distinction (Section 2) and the puppetry-as-archive framing (Section 4) as its analytical spine.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi and explain their dramatic use. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The pair separates realistic representation from stylised symbolic convention and provides a method for analysing how Indian performance moves between everyday action and codified theatrical language.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.
- Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration.
- The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance.

Qualified conclusion: The pair separates realistic representation from stylised symbolic convention and provides a method for analysing how Indian performance moves between everyday action and codified theatrical language.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Distinguish Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi and explain their dramatic use. Answer in about 150...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The pair separates realistic representation from stylised symbolic convention and provides a method for analysing how Indian performance moves between everyday action and codified theatrical language.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Lokadharmi denotes realistic representation of daily life, while Natyadharmi denotes conventional, stylised and symbolic narration. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records multi-act structure, rare staged tragedy, male protagonists who ordinarily achieve their aim and closure restoring order; these are prescriptive conventions, not a census of every performance. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead

of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: The pair separates realistic representation from stylised symbolic convention and provides a method for analysing how Indian performance moves between everyday action and codified theatrical language.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish Lokadharmi and Natyadharmi and explain their dramatic use. Answer in about 150...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Classify Indian puppetry by mechanism with named examples. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: String, shadow, rod and glove forms are defined by control technology; Kathputli, Tholu Bommalata, Putul Nach and Pavakoothu should be matched to mechanism and region.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.
- Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers.
- Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary.
- Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.

Qualified conclusion: String, shadow, rod and glove forms are defined by control technology; Kathputli, Tholu Bommalata, Putul Nach and Pavakoothu should be matched to mechanism and region.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Classify Indian puppetry by mechanism with named examples. Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: String, shadow, rod and glove forms are defined by control technology; Kathputli, Tholu Bommalata, Putul Nach and Pavakoothu should be matched to mechanism and region.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: String, shadow, rod and glove forms are defined by control technology; Kathputli, Tholu Bommalata, Putul Nach and Pavakoothu should be matched to mechanism and region.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise three named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Classify Indian puppetry by mechanism with named examples. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why did Sanskrit theatre contract, and in what sense does Kutiyattam complicate a decline narrative? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Literary, linguistic and patronage shifts weakened court Sanskrit drama, but a regional temple institution preserved living performance; contraction is therefore not extinction.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts.
- Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct.
- Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses.

Qualified conclusion: Literary, linguistic and patronage shifts weakened court Sanskrit drama, but a regional temple institution preserved living performance; contraction is therefore not extinction.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Why did Sanskrit theatre contract, and in what sense does Kutiyattam complicate a decline...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Literary, linguistic and patronage shifts weakened court Sanskrit drama, but a regional temple institution preserved living performance; contraction is therefore not extinction.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The source attributes Sanskrit theatre's contraction to writers moving toward poetry and song, difficult rule-bound Sanskrit losing reach, and changed patronage under later courts. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Kutiyattam preserves a living Kerala Sanskrit-theatre lineage with codified gesture, Sanskrit-Prakrit-Malayalam use, Nirvahana and temple-theatre institutions; Sanskrit theatre is therefore not wholly extinct. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different

safeguarding responses. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Literary, linguistic and patronage shifts weakened court Sanskrit drama, but a regional temple institution preserved living performance; contraction is therefore not extinction.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Why did Sanskrit theatre contract, and in what sense does Kutiyattam complicate a decline...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the development of modern Indian theatre as a social and political medium. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Colonial proscenium commerce, censorship, Parsi circulation, nationalist-social drama, IPTA mobilisation and post-Independence institutions created successive publics.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.
- Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect.
- Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies.
- Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training.

Qualified conclusion: Colonial proscenium commerce, censorship, Parsi circulation, nationalist-social drama, IPTA mobilisation and post-Independence institutions created successive publics.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the development of modern Indian theatre as a social and political medium. Answer in...”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Colonial proscenium commerce, censorship, Parsi circulation, nationalist-social drama, IPTA mobilisation and post-Independence institutions created successive publics.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Colonial urban theatre adopted commercial proscenium spaces and addressed social and political themes; the Dramatic Performances Act of 1876 demonstrates state concern with its political effect. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Parsi theatre linked commercial multilingual melodrama to early cinema, while IPTA organised theatre around famine and social mobilisation; they represent different modern performance economies. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Prithvi Theatre, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National School of Drama and regional repertoires shifted support toward touring, ticketing, grants and formal training. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Colonial proscenium commerce, censorship, Parsi circulation, nationalist-social drama, IPTA mobilisation and post-Independence institutions created successive publics.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise five named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the development of modern Indian theatre as a social and political medium. Answer in...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss puppetry as an archive and a vulnerable living tradition. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Mechanism-specific regional forms transmit epics and philosophy through integrated craft, music and theatre, yet current audience and funding pressures require performer-centred safeguarding rather than museum preservation alone.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region.
- Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers.
- Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary.
- Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavaakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms.
- References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.
- The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskere, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example.

Qualified conclusion: Mechanism-specific regional forms transmit epics and philosophy through integrated craft, music and theatre, yet current audience and funding pressures require performer-centred safeguarding rather than museum preservation alone.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on “Discuss puppetry as an archive and a vulnerable living tradition. Answer in about 300 words.”, every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Mechanism-specific regional forms transmit epics and philosophy through integrated craft, music and theatre, yet current audience and funding pressures require performer-centred safeguarding rather than

museum preservation alone.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Indian puppetry is classified into string, shadow, rod and glove forms; mechanism, construction and movement must be named before region. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Kathputli uses legless finger-string dolls, Kundhei uses more jointed Odissi-influenced figures, and Gombeyatta adapts Yakshagana character design with multiple puppeteers. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Tholu Bommalata, Togalu Gombeyatta and Ravana Chhaya project cut-outs against a lit screen; leather, opacity, scale and regional narrative practice vary. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Putul Nach and Yampuri use rods from below or behind, while Kerala Pavaakoothu uses fingers inside a sleeve-like body to control head and arms. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner documents lack of funding and captive audience as current pressures and names Anupama Hoskote, Dhaatu and a 2020 SNA Puraskar as a bounded revival example. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Mechanism-specific regional forms transmit epics and philosophy through integrated craft, music and theatre, yet current audience and funding pressures require performer-centred safeguarding rather than museum preservation alone.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss puppetry as an archive and a vulnerable living tradition. Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine India's performance traditions as a continuum of ritual, theatre, martial practice and public communication. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Codified Sanskrit drama, folk theatre, puppetry and martial display use different institutions and bodies but repeatedly combine narrative, music, gesture and community; analysis must preserve their distinct ecologies.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas.

- Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies.
- References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone.
- Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display.
- Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses.

Qualified conclusion: Codified Sanskrit drama, folk theatre, puppetry and martial display use different institutions and bodies but repeatedly combine narrative, music, gesture and community; analysis must preserve their distinct ecologies.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine India's performance traditions as a continuum of ritual, theatre, martial practice...", every clause and time boundary, common-axis organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Codified Sanskrit drama, folk theatre, puppetry and martial display use different institutions and bodies but repeatedly combine narrative, music, gesture and community; analysis must preserve their distinct ecologies.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Bharata's layered Natyashastra codifies plot, character, rasa, preliminaries and staging while narrating theatre as a Natya Veda assembled from the four Vedas. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Folk theatre developed through devotional themes, romance and local heroes, and later social messages, using regional language and rural performance ecologies. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** References in the Mahabharata and Silappadikaram and the Bhagavad Gita's puppeteer metaphor support puppetry as a vehicle of epic, devotional and philosophical transmission, not children's entertainment alone. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Kalaripayattu, Silambam, Thang-ta, Gatka, Mardani Khel and Pari-khanda or Chhau-linked forms differ by weapon, pedagogy, community and degree of staged display. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Classical Sanskrit theatre underwent historical contraction yet retains living Kutiyattam continuity, while puppetry faces ongoing policy-actionable vulnerability; the two require different safeguarding responses. **Analysis:** Link form, medium, technique, patronage or performance context to the directive instead of merely listing the example. **Qualification:** State its chronological, regional, attributional or status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A shared motif, material, religious setting or institutional label does not by itself establish identical function, direct descent, homogeneous community meaning or complete safeguarding.

Qualified conclusion: Codified Sanskrit drama, folk theatre, puppetry and martial display use different institutions and bodies but repeatedly combine narrative, music, gesture and community; analysis must preserve their distinct ecologies.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence definition and thesis; organise six to eight named monuments, objects, forms, texts, practitioners, communities or institutions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded close.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, compares like with like, connects form and patronage to social meaning, and avoids list-making, essentialism, false continuity and unsupported attribution.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine India's performance traditions as a continuum of ritual, theatre, martial practice...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named monument, object, text, technique, community or official record and state what that evidence cannot prove.